

PC COMPONENTS LET'S BUILD SOMETHING ... 'APPROPRIATE'



For gaming, productivity, and everything else!

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Building a DIY desktop PC is an exciting and rewarding venture. For quite a few, it's a rite of passage. A DIY PC offers the flexibility to tailor your system to your exact needs and often provides better value for money compared to pre-built systems. The problem of plenty may make this process daunting. While not exhaustive, by following the guidelines we bring for you, you can ensure that you get your performance requirements and budget constraints.

GENERAL POINTERS

We'll start off with some general pointers that are applicable to all the three builds that we're going to be talking about.

1. **Purpose and Use Case:** Define your needs. Gaming, content creation, office work, and general use have different requirements.
2. **Compatibility:** Ensure all selected components are compatible with each other. If you're doubtful, check websites such as PCPartPicker.
3. **Future-Proofing:** Consider components that offer some level of future-proofing. However, don't let this be your primary guiding principle.
4. **Budget Allocation:** Allocate your budget wisely.

5. **Research and Reviews:** Read reviews and benchmarks for components to understand their real-world performance and reliability.
6. **Warranty and Support:** Check the warranty and support for each component. Check popular forums to see what kind of after-sales experience in the region.
7. **Aesthetics vs. Performance:** While aesthetics can be important, always prioritise performance and functionality over looks.

ENTRY-LEVEL (UNDER ₹5,000)

An entry-level PC build is perfect for users who need a basic system for tasks such as web browsing, office work, and light gaming. The focus here is on value for money and cost-effectiveness.

1. Processor

Prioritise the processor. There are several budget-friendly processors with decent integrated graphics that eliminate the need for a dedicated GPU, reducing overall costs. AMD Ryzen 3 and Intel Core i3 processors are good choices in this category. However, we usually recommend the next tier. The AMD Ryzen 5 4600G, 8500G, and the Intel Core i5 12400 are good candidates. Allocate about 10-12K for the processor. Also, avoid getting a processor without an iGPU if you're not planning on getting a GPU.

2. Motherboard

Opt for the cheapest motherboard that meets your needs. Ensure it supports the chosen CPU and has enough expansion slots and ports for future upgrades. The A520 or A620 chipset for AMD (depending on the socket) or the H610 chipset for Intel are excellent choices. They provide all the necessary features without unnecessary extras.

3. Storage

Aim to get an NVMe M.2 SSD for your boot drive. A 256 GB or 512 GB NVMe SSD should suffice. The speed advantage of NVMe SSDs results in faster boot times and overall snappier performance. This difference is all the more noticeable as the system ages.

4. RAM

A minimum of 16 GB of RAM is recommended. While 8 GB might be tempting, 16 GB provides a much better experience. With DDR4, opt for 3200-3600 MT/s as the speed and for DDR5, go for 4800-5200 MT/s. You should ideally get two sticks for DDR4 machines whereas DDR5 can make do with just one stick since it has dual-channel built into each module.

5. Second-Hand Components

Consider purchasing second-hand components to save costs. Items such as moni-